Constrained static hedging of a capped GBM claim

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Abstract

A capped European claim under geometric Brownian motion is hedged statically with a stock and one vanilla call under position and funding limits. Initial costs use risk-neutral prices, whereas physical probabilities determine mean-square discounted terminal error. Truncated-lognormal moments yield a strictly convex quadratic loss and a unique constrained hedge. I derive complete optimality conditions, including zero budget and funding shadow prices, and compare 126 hedges with unrestricted, cash-only and competing constrained methods. Outward feasibility and primal-dual bounds resolve arithmetic-floor cases. With known volatility and uncertain physical drift, Gaussian density interpolation bounds risk between grid points and gives a second-order multiplicative grid bound; finite-mixture dual certificates quantify the gap to the continuum minimax optimum. On the diagnostic drift grid, robustness lowers maximum loss in ten of twelve cases, with two ties, but raises true-drift loss in those same ten cases. The guarantees concern population mean-square loss under the stipulated model, separating funding constraints, drift uncertainty and numerical error.

Keywords: static hedging; mean-square loss; physical measure; convex optimisation; funding constraints; drift uncertainty; robust hedging; shadow prices.

JEL classification: C61, C63, G13.

1 Financial model and funded loss

I study how position and funding constraints alter static hedging of a capped claim under a classical geometric Brownian motion (GBM) model. Static quadratic hedging with pricing-measure cost constraints is established (Leung and Lorig, 2016); I specialise it to a two-instrument basis and a fixed no-arbitrage premium. Fixed-capital mean-square loss also appears in constrained dynamic hedging (Czichowsky and Schweizer, 2012), but the existence proof here is finite-dimensional. [1] The underlying GBM market remains dynamically complete. Residual risk arises from the restricted instrument set and static positions. Physical parameters are stipulated for synthetic comparisons.

Let $S, K, H, T, \sigma > 0$, let r, q, μ be finite constants, and set $J = K + H$, $D = e^{-rT}$ and $a = e^{(q-r)T}$. Under the physical measure,

$$X = S\exp\{(\mu - q - \sigma^2/2)T + \sigma\sqrt{T}Z\}, \qquad Z \sim N(0,1), \qquad Y = D\min\{(X-K)^+, H\}. \quad (1)$$

Here μ is the total-return drift. I price the contract under the stipulated equivalent measure Q, whose ex-dividend drift is $r - q$. For strike A, let

$$\begin{aligned} C_A &= Se^{-qT}\Phi(d_{1,A}) - AD\Phi(d_{2,A}), \\ d_{1,A} &= \frac{\log(S/A) + (r - q + \sigma^2/2)T}{\sigma\sqrt{T}}, \quad d_{2,A} = d_{1,A} - \sigma\sqrt{T}. \end{aligned} \quad (2)$$

[1] The closest static antecedent was read in its identified author preprint; its published successor metadata was verified. The source ledger records that distinction and the limited sections actually consulted.

These classical prices follow Black and Scholes (1973) and Merton (1973). The received premium is $V_0 = C_K - C_J > 0$. Under Q, terminal stock has a strictly positive lognormal density on $(0, \infty)$. The non-negative call and capped payoffs are positive on sets of positive probability, so their finite discounted expectations give $C_K > 0$ and $V_0 > 0$. I allow only the total-return stock, with dividends reinvested, and the vanilla call at K. Their initial costs and discounted gains are

$$p = (S, C_K)^\top, \qquad g = (aX - S,\ D(X-K)^+ - C_K)^\top. \tag{3}$$

For fixed holdings $\theta = (\theta_s, \theta_c)^\top$, the initial bank balance is $V_0 - p^\top\theta$. The self-financing portfolio's discounted terminal wealth is $V_0 + \theta^\top g$, so the discounted liability residual and loss are

$$R(\theta) = Y - V_0 - \theta^\top g, \qquad L(\theta) = \mathbb{E}_P[R(\theta)^2] = c - 2h^\top\theta + \theta^\top M\theta, \tag{4}$$

where $M = \mathbb{E}_P[gg^\top]$, $h = \mathbb{E}_P[g(Y - V_0)]$ and $c = \mathbb{E}_P[(Y - V_0)^2]$. This is uncentred mean-square financial loss, including squared bias, rather than residual variance alone. It penalises discounted terminal surplus and shortfall symmetrically; the pricing premium is fixed, not chosen to minimise this loss. I impose the declared box and instrument-spend budget

$$\mathcal{F}_B = \{\theta : 0 \le \theta_s, \theta_c \le 1,\ p^\top\theta \le B\}, \qquad B = \kappa V_0, \quad \kappa \ge 0. \tag{5}$$

For $\kappa \le 1$ the bank balance is non-negative; for $\kappa > 1$ borrowing may occur. These position bounds are modelling choices, not universal limits on optimal hedges.

2 Convexity and constrained optimality

The relevant convex optimality principles are established (Boyd and Vandenberghe, 2004). The following specialisation includes the zero-budget boundary, where strict feasibility fails.

Theorem 2.1 (Existence, uniqueness and optimality)**.** *The matrix M is positive definite and $\mathcal{F}_B$ is nonempty and compact. The constrained hedge is unique. Its necessary and sufficient conditions are feasibility, non-negative multipliers $\ell, u \in \mathbb{R}^2$ and $\lambda \in \mathbb{R}$, and*

$$2(M\theta - h) - \ell + u + \lambda p = 0, \tag{6}$$

$$\ell_i\theta_i = 0, \quad u_i(\theta_i - 1) = 0, \quad \lambda(p^\top\theta - B) = 0. \tag{7}$$

These conditions also hold at $B = 0$, although strict feasibility fails there. The optimum lies among at most sixteen candidates: the unconstrained stationary point, stationary points on five supporting lines and their ten pairwise intersections, retaining only well-defined feasible candidates.

Appendix A gives full proofs and closed Gaussian moment expressions for every objective coefficient. It also expresses risk as an integral of three squared affine residuals. No finite hedge in this instrument span replicates the capped claim exactly; apparent zero risk from subtracting nearly equal floating-point moments is therefore a numerical warning. A long call at K and short call at J would replicate the claim, but that second call is unavailable here.

3 Loss choice and the value of funding

3.1 Variance minimisation and mean-square hedging

The financial objective also explains why variance-reduction controls cannot simply be reused as optimal hedges. Put $m = \mathbb{E}_P g$, $e = \mathbb{E}_P(Y - V_0)$, $G = \mathrm{Cov}_P(g)$ and $k = \mathrm{Cov}_P(g, Y - V_0)$. With $\theta_v = G^{-1}k$, $\zeta = m^\top G^{-1}m$ and $\eta = e - m^\top\theta_v$, the unrestricted mean-square relaxation is

$$\theta_M = M^{-1}h = \theta_v + \frac{G^{-1}m\,\eta}{1+\zeta}, \qquad L(\theta_v) - L(\theta_M) = \frac{\eta^2\zeta}{1+\zeta}. \tag{8}$$

Contract	S	K	H	T	r	q	σ
Lower kink	100	100	20	1	0.03	0.01	0.2
Upper kink	120	100	20	1	0.03	0.01	0.2
Inside spread	110	100	20	1	0.03	0.01	0.2
Deep cap	160	100	20	1	0.03	0.01	0.2
Short dated	100	100	20	0.05	0.03	0.01	0.06
Negative rate/dividend	105	100	20	1	-0.015	0.045	0.25
High volatility	95	100	30	2	0.03	0.01	0.65

Table 1: Designed one-asset inputs. Instrument costs and the received premium use Q; terminal loss uses the specified physical drift. No input is a market estimate.

Under $P = Q$, $m = e = 0$ and the objectives coincide; different measures permit, but do not force, a strict difference. This unrestricted L^2 benchmark can contain short positions and is not automatically admissible under the bounded-below wealth condition. Constraints add the exact penalty $L(\theta_B) - L(\theta_M) = (\theta_B - \theta_M)^\top M(\theta_B - \theta_M)$.

3.2 Budget shadow prices

The optimal risk $v(B) = \min_{\mathcal{F}_B} L$ is non-increasing and convex. Every budget multiplier yields the global supporting bound

$$v(B') \geq v(B) - \lambda_B(B' - B), \qquad B' \geq 0. \tag{9}$$

On a regular active-set interval, $v'(B) = -\lambda_B$ and v is quadratic or constant. At zero budget, $v'(0+) = -2\max\{0, h_s/S, h_c/C_K\}$: the initial marginal benefit of available budget is the largest positive loss-reduction/cost ratio; unhelpful spending is not required. The budget here permits spending; it does not require the entire amount to be invested.

4 Registered comparisons and numerical evidence

I retain the seven designed contracts in Table 1. The protocol was saved before outcomes, with physical total-return drifts $\mu \in \{0.03, 0.06, 0.12\}$ and budget multiples $\kappa \in \{0, 0.25, 0.5, 1, 2, 4\}$. This gives 126 constrained mean-square comparisons. Rates are annualised; maturities are in years. The parameters are synthetic, with no licensed or empirical observations. The experiment assumes a known physical law; it does not fit μ.

The analytic unconstrained solution is the strongest two-instrument relaxation, and cash-only financing is the no-hedge baseline. I compare the constrained solution with a separately solved centred-variance objective using the same constraints, a Euclidean projection heuristic, and SciPy's general-purpose SLSQP optimiser. The projection heuristic minimises distance from unrestricted variance-optimal holdings; it does not minimise financial loss. The exact call-spread reference uses an additional call and a short position, so it identifies the importance of the instrument restriction rather than superiority within a shared feasible set.

Closed truncated moments determine objective coefficients. Independent adaptive normal integration, split at both payoff kinks, checks 168 mean/product coefficients. Risk is reported primarily by integrating the non-negative squared residual, with the expanded moment quadratic retained alongside it. I do not replace negative computed risks with zero or repair eigenvalues. The numerical mean-square matrix condition number reaches $42,337$, despite exact positive definiteness. Thus numerical representation remains a separate issue from the convexity proof.

No registered optimiser failure or quadrature warning occurred. Maximum scaled primal violation is 1.88×10^{-14}; maximum negative multiplier magnitude is 2.84×10^{-14}. The largest stationarity and complementary-slackness residuals are 4.55×10^{-13} and 2.76×10^{-15} respectively.

Contract	No hedge	Constrained	Unrestricted	Reduction (%)
Lower kink	68.4032	15.7205	13.5707	77.02
Upper kink	58.6954	24.9738	20.2983	57.45
Inside spread	71.9973	22.9439	19.0941	68.13
Deep cap	6.06651	5.23772	4.218	13.66
Short dated	0.770884	Unresolved	Unresolved	n/a
Negative rate/dividend	85.0105	24.4634	20.1739	71.22
High volatility	151.748	77.0938	57.1103	49.20

Table 2: Population-risk diagnostics at $\mu = 0.06$ and $B = V_0$. Losses are squared discounted monetary units. The percentage compares the constrained mean-square hedge with cash-only financing. Unrestricted holdings relax the box and budget. The original short-dated hedge calculations lie below a heuristic arithmetic floor and support neither a resolved risk ratio nor a zero-risk assertion; Section 4.1 supplies the validated extension.

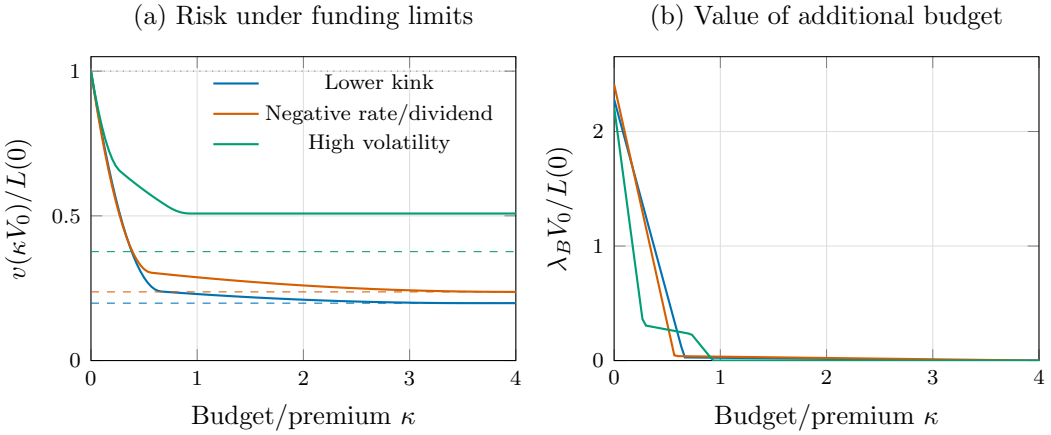


Figure 1: Funding and residual risk for three registered contractual scenarios at $\mu = 0.06$. Solid curves use the constrained mean-square hedge; dashed horizontal levels give each two-instrument unrestricted relaxation. The dotted level is the cash-only baseline. The right panel shows the normalised budget multiplier, equal to the marginal reduction in normalised risk on regular active-set intervals. At zero I use the proved right derivative. A supplemental 121-point grid illustrates curvature and saturation; all seven contracts remain in the primary comparison. These are synthetic floating-point diagnostics.

These are floating-point diagnostics, not exact feasibility or admissibility certificates. SLSQP's residual-square risks differ from the active-set values by between -2.27×10^{-13} and 1.59×10^{-11}, with maximum position difference 2.34×10^{-7}. The small negative comparison remains visible. Equation (26) states the exact prerequisites needed to translate residuals into a risk bound.

Among the 117 constrained rows above the heuristic floor, reductions against the no-hedge baseline range from zero to 81.5868 per cent. The largest same-constraint variance-objective penalty is 0.191175 squared monetary units, or 0.5982 per cent of the mean-square optimum, for the negative-rate/dividend contract at $\mu = 0.12$, $\kappa = 0.5$. The distinction is mathematically substantive but quantitatively modest in this registered family. Euclidean projection has a largest penalty of 612.244, illustrating why geometric closeness to an unconstrained holding is not a financial risk criterion.

Figure 1 links the funding constraint to both residual risk and its local marginal value. I use two-dimensional curves because each panel varies one budget parameter. The supplemental grid adds resolution to the function, not further selected hedge trials. The primary tables retain every registered contract and physical law.

I also evaluate all holdings on 65,536 independent normal paths per contract/physical-law regime, using seed 674193 plus $1009(3i + j)$ for zero-based contract and drift indices. The same paths compare the methods within a regime, yielding 420 Monte Carlo rows. No path is used to fit a hedge and no raw paths are retained. The reported standard errors concern sample means of squared residuals and are asymptotic diagnostics. All residual fourth moments are finite under the stipulated lognormal law, supporting the usual independent-sample convergence assumptions; these standard errors are not finite-sample coverage certificates. The maximum absolute standardised discrepancy is 2.21075. Two rows exceed 1.96, but they use identical holdings and the same paths, so they are not independent observations or simultaneous coverage evidence.

Three negative expanded-quadratic risks and nine heuristic-floor constrained rows remain in the archive. The floor is $128\epsilon_{\mathrm{mach}}$ times the sum of absolute quadratic terms; it is a diagnostic choice, not a proved roundoff bound. For the short-dated case the residual-square calculation gives values around 10^{-30}–10^{-28} for near-unit-call holdings, while moment subtraction can report zero or a negative number. The true two-instrument optimum is strictly positive by the proof. In that original floating-point study, numerical positivity alone did not resolve its magnitude: tiny coefficient/funding errors and rare unsampled tails can dominate these computed risks.

4.1 Validated loss and feasible numerical hedges

I resolve the arithmetic-floor cases using outward price, moment and optimality bounds while preserving the original computations. Each retained binary64 parameter and holding denotes its exact rational value. The new calculation uses exact model prices at those inputs; the archived implementation used rounded prices. I therefore distinguish an original holding, its explicitly feasible replacement and a refined holding, rather than attributing every difference to risk evaluation. The upper-strike call remains strictly positive even when its cost is lost in ordinary floating-point subtraction. Appendix A.7 derives the feasibility and primal-dual certificates used to bound both risk and distance from the unique constrained optimum.

I evaluate 168 stored portfolios and refine all 126 primary constrained hedges. Independent 160-digit piecewise moments and quadratic programmes agree with the outward risk and optimum bounds. Sixty scaled positive integrals check all 21 cash-only and 21 unrestricted holdings, the nine original floor holdings and their nine refined replacements. All refined hedges are exactly feasible and all certificates resolve at 256 bits; the largest certified relative optimality gap is below 4.32×10^{-26}. These comparisons check distinct representations of the stipulated model, rather than observed market performance.

Of the original 126 primary holdings, 75 satisfy both exact box and fair-price budget constraints and 51 violate at least one. The budget-only split is 85/41; 17 have a box violation, with seven in both groups. The largest budget and box violations are below 1.89×10^{-12} monetary units and 3.37×10^{-18} units respectively. For the stored SLSQP holdings the joint split is 86/40. These tiny violations matter for an exact certificate without implying a material trading loss. Feasibility repair can increase loss: at $\mu = 0.12$, $\kappa = 1$, the short-dated holding's repaired loss is about 1.05×10^{-23}, before refinement reduces it to the bound in Table 3.

At $\mu = 0.06$, the archived positive integral is 1.64531×10^{-29}, close to the exact-fair-price risk 1.64216×10^{-29} of that same stored holding. It therefore need not be an inaccurate integral of its implemented residual. The much smaller optimum follows after refinement. The upper-strike call costs about 6.86×10^{-43} and rules out exact unit-call funding at $\kappa = 1$. The current certificates do not resolve the much smaller difference between the optimal losses at $\kappa = 1$ and $\kappa = 2$. Nor can the original 65,536-path Monte Carlo experiment confirm an upper-tail contribution beyond 13 normal standard deviations.

μ	Archived quadratic	Original holding, fair-price loss	Certified $v(V_0)$ interval
0.03	0	2.23792×10^{-30}	$[1.60915, 1.60916] \times 10^{-43}$
0.06	-2.22045×10^{-16}	1.64216×10^{-29}	$[7.43078, 7.43079] \times 10^{-43}$
0.12	0	1.03616×10^{-28}	$[1.52713, 1.52714] \times 10^{-41}$

Table 3: Short-dated contract at $\kappa = 1$. Original holdings and primitive parameters retain their exact binary64 values. The middle risk column summarises outward evaluation at exact model prices; the final column rounds the certified optimum bracket outwards. The archived quadratic uses the original rounded coefficients. Refinement changes holdings; it is not merely a more accurate evaluation of the stored portfolio. Losses are squared discounted monetary units.

5 Hedging when the physical drift is uncertain

The preceding comparisons stipulate the physical drift. Historical mean returns are noisy even when volatility is known, so precision in numerical hedging does not establish precision about the physical law. I retain the same known volatility under P and Q, and hold the no-arbitrage prices, premium and feasible set fixed. Only the physical total-return drift varies over a finite interval $I = [\mu_-, \mu_+]$. I minimise worst-case discounted mean-square loss,

$$v_I = \min_{\theta \in \mathcal{F}_B} F_I(\theta), \qquad F_I(\theta) = \sup_{\mu \in I} L_\mu(\theta). \tag{10}$$

This is uncertainty about the hedging criterion, rather than a change to risk-neutral pricing. It preserves the fixed static instrument restriction.

Confidence-region-based robust portfolio formulations are established (Goldfarb and Iyengar, 2003). I apply that principle to the fixed-premium hedging loss and explicitly control the numerical reduction to a finite grid.

A finite drift grid can certify the whole interval. Let its ordered points include both endpoints and have largest spacing δ, and put $\gamma = \exp\{T\delta^2/(8\sigma^2)\}$. Gaussian density interpolation and Hölder's inequality give, simultaneously for every feasible hedge,

$$\max_j L_{\mu_j}(\theta) \le F_I(\theta) \le \gamma \max_j L_{\mu_j}(\theta). \tag{11}$$

The worst drift need not be an endpoint. The factor bounds what a grid could miss, rather than assuming endpoint maximisation. If d is a validated lower bound on the finite-grid optimum and U is a validated upper bound on the grid loss of an exactly feasible candidate $\widehat{\theta}$, then

$$d \le v_I \le F_I(\widehat{\theta}) \le \gamma U, \qquad F_I(\widehat{\theta}) - v_I \le \gamma U - d. \tag{12}$$

Appendix B proves this certificate, uniqueness of the robust hedge, second-order multiplicative grid convergence, and the finite-mixture dual lower bound. These are applications of established Gaussian, Hölder and convex-duality arguments, without a theoretical-priority claim.

An independent historical Gaussian sample gives an exact finite-sample drift confidence interval when volatility is known. I enlarge it for specified observation-rounding radii and numerical quantile bounds. Under the stated historical/future model, the probability of both successful return and a reported upper bound below the chosen hedge's true future mean-square loss is at most α. This is a joint error bound with possible computational non-return, not conditional coverage after selecting successful runs. Unknown volatility, changing physical drift and misspecified returns remain outside this experiment.

5.1 Synthetic comparisons and the cost of protection

I retain three original contracts, two drift half-widths (0.03 and 0.15 around 0.06), and two budgets ($\kappa = 0.5, 1$): 12 comparisons. The comparator set contains the centre-drift hedge,

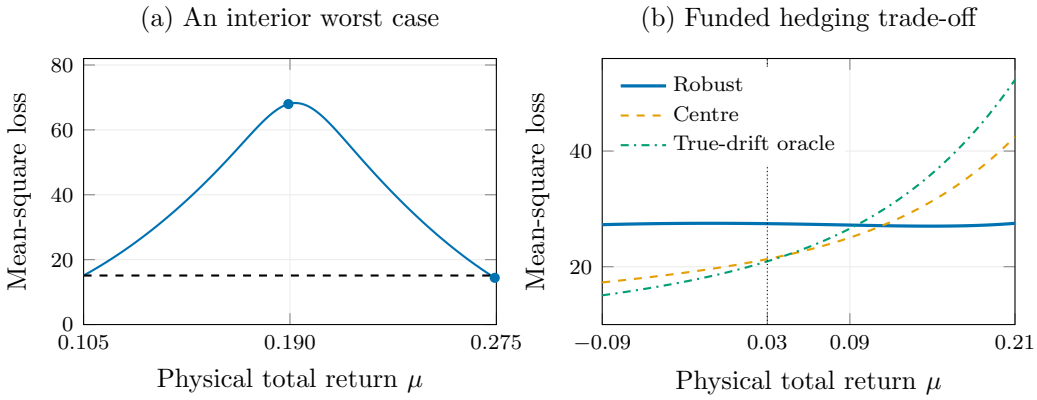


Figure 2: Physical-drift risk, in squared discounted monetary units. Panel (a) displays the fixed admissible counterexample; the dashed line is its endpoint maximum, which fails to bound interior risk. Panel (b) displays the inside-spread contract with half-width 0.15 and $\kappa = 1$. The vertical line marks the stipulated true drift 0.03. The robust hedge protects worst-case loss while sacrificing performance there. Curves are independent 160-digit evaluations rendered at 257 points; they illustrate the argument, while the analytic cell factor supplies the continuum guarantee. Panel selection is illustrative after outcomes; all 12 primary comparisons remain retained.

the oracle at the stipulated true drift 0.03, cash-only financing, and an endpoint-only minimax proposal. Every trading comparator uses the same instruments, box and funding constraints. Independent 160-digit piecewise moments check 204 node-risk intervals, 12 mixture duals and 12 finite-grid optimisers. A 257-point drift grid supplies 15,420 baseline-risk diagnostics. All certificates resolve; the largest relative continuum-optimality gap is below 0.084 per cent, using 9 or 33 nodes at 256-bit precision. The confidence-based examples below use 65 nodes and satisfy the same bound.

On the diagnostic drift grid, robustness reduces worst-case risk in 10 of 12 cases, with two ties; the largest reduction is 35.22 per cent. At the stipulated true drift, however, it increases risk in those same ten cases, by up to 37.38 per cent. I retain both findings. The objective protects against an interval of physical laws; it does not minimise loss at every member of that interval. For the inside-spread contract with half-width 0.15 and $\kappa = 1$, the endpoint-only portfolio misses an interior loss increase of 0.218679 squared monetary units at drift $-207/12800$. Even the robust portfolio's largest diagnostic loss is slightly above its endpoint maximum. Thus endpoint checks alone would not justify the reported continuum certificate.

Figure 2 makes the distinction visible. Panel (a) is a separately declared admissible counterexample: $S = K = 100$, $H = 20$, $T = 1$, $r = 0.03$, $q = 0.01$, $\sigma = 0.01$, $\theta = (0, 0.5)$ and $\mu \in [0.105, 0.275]$ at $\kappa = 1$. The losses at drifts $0.105, 0.19, 0.275$ are respectively $15.1172, 68.0854, 14.1002$. The middle value exceeds the endpoint maximum by a factor greater than 4.50.

I also retain 30 fixed-seed historical datasets of 252 equally spaced returns, rounded to six decimal places. The known-volatility confidence interval contains the stipulated drift in 27 of 30 examples. This is a small synthetic diagnostic, not an empirical demonstration of nominal 95 per cent coverage. I feed the first three predetermined intervals[2] into the robust decision and compare 3,084 additional dense-grid risks. All three intervals contain the true drift 0.06, and no reported continuum upper bound understates the corresponding true population loss. Table 4 records the trade-off: all three robust hedges have greater true-drift loss than plug-in hedges,

[2]Historical inference and the future hedge use identical exact dividend and volatility inputs. The protocol records the dividend-input alignment correction; the earlier execution and paper are preserved in the research history.

Dataset	Drift interval	True-drift loss		Grid maximum	
		Robust	Plug-in	Robust	Plug-in
0	$[-0.11113, 0.67310]$	34.1303	23.1837	45.5268	218.0523
1	$[-0.48952, 0.29472]$	23.8600	22.1253	34.3361	188.6487
2	$[-0.33727, 0.44697]$	28.8948	15.7276	37.5867	247.9285

Table 4: Predetermined confidence-to-decision examples, with dataset indices starting at zero. Here $\sigma = 0.2$, $\mu = 0.06$, $\Delta = 1/252$, $q = 0.01$, $\alpha = 0.05$ and $\kappa = 1$. All losses are population expectations under the stipulated GBM law; grid maxima are numerical diagnostics. Interval displays are rounded summaries; exact rational endpoints define the actual decision.

while reducing their diagnostic worst-case loss. Each remains better than cash-only financing at the stipulated true drift.

The protocol was fixed before these current outcomes, with an explicitly recorded informed amendment selecting the first three inference examples. Pseudorandom Gaussian generation is a reproducible numerical design, not a certified continuous Gaussian sampler. The confidence guarantee follows from the model and proof. The study does not establish robustness to unknown volatility, changing drift or misspecified returns.

6 Interpretation and reproducibility

The financial question is how much discounted terminal error remains when a fixed fair premium must fund a restricted static hedge. The exact argument separates initial valuation under Q, physical loss under P, funding feasibility and numerical error. Its useful project-specific conclusions are the loss distinction, the exact constraint penalty and the interpretable budget frontier. These are checked specialisations of established hedging and convex optimisation, with reproducible adverse comparisons.

The engine is `gbm_hedging.py`. Its runner, `run_hedging_study.py`, reads `hedging_protocol.json` and writes a fresh result directory. Python 3.13, NumPy 2.3.5 and SciPy 1.16.3 reproduce the registered computations. Ten tests compare independent moment representations, active-set and general-purpose solutions, budget subgradients, dividend funding and cancellation cases. The source ledger records publication status, actual consulted versions and reading scope. Full derivations follow in the appendix. The validated extension is `src/gbm_hedge_certificate.py`; `scripts/run_hedge_certificate_study.py` runs directly from the organised repository into a new external output directory. The existing certificate environment adds python-flint 0.9.0 and mpmath 1.3.0. Arb supplies outward arithmetic (Johansson, 2017); 21 additional tests cover exact feasibility, optimality, arithmetic boundaries and evidence protection. The retained protocol, exact fractions, source hashes, independent comparisons and failures are in `results/capped_gbm/validated_hedging/`. This is informed development following the original adverse outcomes, not an untouched prospective experiment. The previous companion source and export are preserved in `replication/history/before_validated_hedging/`. The drift extension is `src/gbm_drift_hedging.py`; `scripts/run_drift_hedge_study.py` reads `configs/drift_hedge_protocol.json` directly from the organised tree. Its 21 additional tests cover exact mixture duality, interior-risk failure, zero budget, confidence rounding and numerical abstention. Retained certificates, independent comparisons and all adverse findings are in `results/capped_gbm/drift_uncertainty/`. The previous 11-page companion is preserved in `replication/history/before_drift_uncertainty/`. The existing pricing/calibration companion and main quantum paper retain their previous evidence.

A Moment, optimality and sensitivity proofs

A.1 Discounted financial accounting and exact moments

A fixed unit of the total-return stock has terminal value $e^{qT}X$; continuous dividends are reinvested, making the share count evolve mechanically as e^{qt}. A call pays $(X-K)^+$ and the bank balance accumulates at r. Thus discounted portfolio wealth is $a\theta_s X + D\theta_c(X-K)^+ + V_0 - p^\top\theta = V_0 + \theta^\top g$. For the constrained long-only positions, the available securities have non-negative prices. Discounted wealth is bounded below by the fixed initial bank balance, itself at least $V_0 - B$. This proves admissibility on the finite horizon even when borrowing occurs. The unrestricted L^2 relaxation need not satisfy that condition. Expanding the squared residual gives (4). All moments are finite because lognormal variables have every positive integer moment.

Write $b = \log S + (\mu - q - \sigma^2/2)T$, $v = \sigma\sqrt{T}$ and $t_j = \mathbb{E}_P X^j = \exp(jb + j^2v^2/2)$. For $j = 0, 1, 2$, define

$$\begin{aligned} T_j(l,u) &= \mathbb{E}_P[X^j \mathbf{1}_{\{l<X\le u\}}] \\ &= t_j\left[\Phi\left(\frac{\log u - b - jv^2}{v}\right) - \Phi\left(\frac{\log l - b - jv^2}{v}\right)\right]. \end{aligned} \tag{13}$$

The conventions $\log 0 = -\infty$ and $\log\infty = \infty$ cover tails. To derive this formula, integrate $e^{j(b+vz)}\varphi(z)$ over the corresponding normal interval. Completing the square, $jvz - z^2/2 = -(z-jv)^2/2 + j^2v^2/2$, gives the displayed Gaussian probability. Interval endpoints have zero probability.

Let $F = \min\{(X-K)^+, H\}$ and $A = (X-K)^+$. Put $f_0 = \mathbb{E}F$, $f_1 = \mathbb{E}XF$, $f_2 = \mathbb{E}F^2$ and $a_0 = \mathbb{E}A$, $a_1 = \mathbb{E}XA$, $a_2 = \mathbb{E}A^2$. Splitting at K, J gives

$$\begin{aligned} f_0 &= T_1(K,J) - KT_0(K,J) + HT_0(J,\infty), \\ f_1 &= T_2(K,J) - KT_1(K,J) + HT_1(J,\infty), \\ f_2 &= T_2(K,J) - 2KT_1(K,J) + K^2T_0(K,J) + H^2T_0(J,\infty), \end{aligned} \tag{14}$$

$$\begin{aligned} a_0 &= T_1(K,\infty) - KT_0(K,\infty), \\ a_1 &= T_2(K,\infty) - KT_1(K,\infty), \\ a_2 &= T_2(K,\infty) - 2KT_1(K,\infty) + K^2T_0(K,\infty), \end{aligned} \tag{15}$$

$$\begin{aligned} z = \mathbb{E}FA &= T_2(K,J) - 2KT_1(K,J) + K^2T_0(K,J) \\ &\quad + H\{T_1(J,\infty) - KT_0(J,\infty)\}. \end{aligned} \tag{16}$$

Expansion of the instrument gains now supplies

$$\begin{aligned} m &= (at_1 - S,\ Da_0 - C_K)^\top, \\ M_{ss} &= a^2t_2 - 2aSt_1 + S^2, \\ M_{cc} &= D^2a_2 - 2DC_Ka_0 + C_K^2, \\ M_{sc} &= aDa_1 - aC_Kt_1 - SDa_0 + SC_K, \\ h_s &= aDf_1 - SDf_0 - V_0(at_1 - S), \\ h_c &= D^2z - DC_Kf_0 - V_0(Da_0 - C_K), \end{aligned} \tag{17}$$

$$c = D^2f_2 - 2DV_0f_0 + V_0^2, \qquad e = Df_0 - V_0. \tag{18}$$

There is a separate positive-integral representation. On the successive regions $(0,K)$, (K,J) and (J,∞), write $R = A_iX + B_i$. The coefficients are

$$\begin{aligned} (A_1,A_2,A_3) &= (-a\theta_s,\ D(1-\theta_c) - a\theta_s,\ -D\theta_c - a\theta_s), \\ B_1 &= -V_0 + S\theta_s + C_K\theta_c, \\ B_2 &= -DK(1-\theta_c) - V_0 + S\theta_s + C_K\theta_c, \\ B_3 &= DH + DK\theta_c - V_0 + S\theta_s + C_K\theta_c. \end{aligned} \tag{19}$$

Integrating $\sum_i \mathbf{1}_i(A_iX + B_i)^2$ against the positive lognormal density gives the same risk. This mathematical identity does not guarantee that either expanded floating-point calculation is free from cancellation.

A.2 Positive definiteness, existence and the risk penalty

The lognormal density is strictly positive on $(0, \infty)$. If $u^\top Mu = \mathbb{E}(u^\top g)^2 = 0$, continuity makes $u^\top g(x) = 0$ on that whole interval. Below K, its affine slope is au_s, so $u_s = 0$, and its constant is $-u_cC_K$, so $u_c = 0$ because $C_K > 0$. Thus $M \succ 0$. For $G = \mathrm{Cov}(g)$, zero quadratic variance would instead make $u^\top g(x)$ constant. The below-K slope again gives $u_s = 0$, while the above-K slope Du_c gives $u_c = 0$. Hence $G \succ 0$ as well.

The feasible set is closed, bounded and contains zero. Continuity therefore gives existence, and the positive-definite Hessian $2M$ gives strict convexity and uniqueness. Completing the quadratic yields

$$L(\theta) = c - h^\top M^{-1}h + (\theta - \theta_M)^\top M(\theta - \theta_M), \qquad \theta_M = M^{-1}h. \tag{20}$$

This proves the constraint penalty stated in the main text. Nevertheless the unrestricted minimum is strictly positive. If any finite θ made $L = 0$, continuity and positive density would make all three affine residuals identically zero. Their slopes in (19) force, successively, $\theta_s = 0$, $\theta_c = 1$ and $\theta_c = 0$, a contradiction. The unrestricted minimum is attained at θ_M, so this is a strictly positive minimum, not merely positivity at each chosen hedge.

A.3 KKT necessity without a constraint qualification

Write the five inequalities as $A\theta \le b(B)$, with rows $-e_s^\top, -e_c^\top, e_s^\top, e_c^\top, p^\top$ and right sides $0, 0, 1, 1, B$. At a minimiser θ_*, any direction d with $A_Id \le 0$ for the active rows I remains feasible for all sufficiently small positive steps: each inactive inequality has a positive slack. Differentiability gives $\nabla L(\theta_*)^\top d \ge 0$. For completeness, let K_I be the cone of the active row normals. This cone is closed in $\mathbb{R}^2$. Indeed any conic combination reduces to at most two independent normals: for dependent vectors, subtract a scalar multiple of a nonzero linear dependence from the non-negative coefficients until one coefficient vanishes, preserving all remaining non-negativity. Iteration terminates with independence. For a convergent sequence of conic combinations, choose a subsequence using the same independent normals, since there are finitely many choices. Their coefficients are continuous linear functions of the combination and hence have non-negative limits. The limit lies in K_I, proving closedness.

If $w = -\nabla L(\theta_*)$ were outside K_I, let k_0 be its nearest point in that closed convex cone and set $d = w - k_0 \ne 0$. Existence follows by minimising distance on a sufficiently large compact ball. Projection optimality gives $d^\top(k - k_0) \le 0$ for every $k \in K_I$. Taking $k = 0, 2k_0$ gives $d^\top k_0 = 0$, hence $d^\top k \le 0$ for every $k \in K_I$. Thus $A_Id \le 0$, but $\nabla L(\theta_*)^\top d = -w^\top d = -\|d\|^2 < 0$, contradicting the directional inequality. Therefore $w \in K_I$ and has non-negative conic coefficients. These are the active multipliers satisfying $\nabla L + A_I^\top \lambda_I = 0$; inactive multipliers are zero. This proves the polyhedral Farkas argument here and yields (6)–(7). Conversely, for any feasible θ, convexity gives $L(\theta) \ge L(\theta_*) + \nabla L(\theta_*)^\top(\theta - \theta_*)$. Stationarity and complementary slackness make the latter inner product non-negative, proving sufficiency. No strict feasible point is used.

At $B = 0$, positivity of p makes zero the only feasible point. Set upper multipliers to zero and choose $\lambda \ge \max\{0, 2h_s/S, 2h_c/C_K\}$; then lower multipliers $\ell = \lambda p - 2h$ are non-negative and all KKT equations hold. For $B > 0$, sufficiently small positive positions also demonstrate strict feasibility, but necessity does not depend on that observation.

For the exact candidate method, an interior optimum has $\theta = M^{-1}h$. A relative interior point of any nondegenerate face lies on one of the five supporting lines. Writing that line as

$x_0 + tv$, $v \neq 0$, its restricted objective has positive second derivative $2v^\top Mv$, and its unique stationary parameter is

$$t_* = \frac{v^\top (h - Mx_0)}{v^\top Mv}. \tag{21}$$

Keep this candidate only if feasible. Every vertex is an intersection of two independent active line normals. There are at most ten line pairs; parallel pairs have no unique intersection. These alternatives cover an optimum on every face, including the singleton at $B = 0$. Testing at most $1 + 5 + 10 = 16$ candidates therefore finds the global minimum; duplicate candidates and empty faces can be discarded.

A.4 Why a variance control is a different financial hedge

Expanding means and covariances gives $M = G + mm^\top$ and $h = k + me$, hence

$$L(\theta) = \mathrm{Var}(Y - \theta^\top g) + (e - m^\top \theta)^2. \tag{22}$$

The variance minimiser is $\theta_v = G^{-1}k$. The identity $(G + mm^\top)G^{-1}m = (1+\zeta)m$ shows directly that $\theta_v + G^{-1}m\eta/(1+\zeta)$ solves $M\theta = h$. Uniqueness proves (8); substituting the difference into (20) gives $\eta^2(\zeta + \zeta^2)/(1+\zeta)^2 = \eta^2\zeta/(1+\zeta)$. Under $P = Q$, fair discounted instrument gains and claim premia have zero means, so $m = e = 0$. If the measures differ, equality can still hold when $\eta = 0$; a strict discrepancy is not automatic.

A.5 Budget value, shadow prices and local sensitivity

Feasible-set inclusion makes v non-increasing. For $B_1, B_2 \geq 0$, a convex combination of their optimisers is feasible at the same convex combination of budgets. Convexity of L then gives $v(tB_1 + (1-t)B_2) \leq tv(B_1) + (1-t)v(B_2)$ for $0 \leq t \leq 1$. This proves convexity of the value function.

For any optimiser at B and its KKT multipliers, the box multipliers give non-negative terms against any other box-feasible point. The budget term gives $L(\theta) \geq v(B) - \lambda_B(p^\top\theta - p^\top\theta_B)$. If $\lambda_B > 0$, complementary slackness gives $p^\top\theta_B = B$; if it is zero, the term vanishes. For $\theta \in \mathcal{F}_{B'}$, the displayed bound is at least $v(B) - \lambda_B(B' - B)$. Minimising proves (9). Thus $-\lambda_B$ is a subgradient on the budget domain, even at a degenerate budget.

For local differentiability, fix an active set I with independent rows, strictly positive active multipliers and strictly inactive remaining constraints. Put $H_0 = 2M$. The matrix

$$\begin{pmatrix} H_0 & A_I^\top \\ A_I & 0 \end{pmatrix} \tag{23}$$

is invertible: a null vector satisfies $H_0x + A_I^\top y = 0$, $A_Ix = 0$, so $x^\top H_0 x = 0$, hence $x = 0$ and then $y = 0$. The KKT solution is consequently affine in B. Strict inequalities persist on an open neighbourhood, making that affine solution the unique optimum there. If I is nonempty, let $\dot{b}_I$ be the vector with one at the budget row when present and zero elsewhere. Then

$$\begin{aligned} \dot\theta &= H_0^{-1}A_I^\top(A_IH_0^{-1}A_I^\top)^{-1}\dot b_I, \\ v' &= -\lambda_B, \qquad v'' = \dot\theta^\top H_0 \dot\theta \geq 0. \end{aligned} \tag{24}$$

The first identity follows by differentiating the KKT system; the second uses $\nabla L^\top\dot\theta = -\lambda_I^\top\dot b_I$. For an empty active set, $\theta = \theta_M$ is locally constant. At active-set changes or dependent rows, this differentiability argument is not asserted; the global subgradient bound still holds.

In the budget-only active regime, put $z_p = p^\top M^{-1} p > 0$. Solving stationarity and $p^\top \theta = B$ explicitly gives

$$\begin{aligned} \theta &= \theta_M - \frac{p^\top \theta_M - B}{z_p} M^{-1} p, \\ \lambda_B &= \frac{2(p^\top \theta_M - B)}{z_p}, \\ v(B) &= L(\theta_M) + \frac{(p^\top \theta_M - B)^2}{z_p}. \end{aligned} \tag{25}$$

These formulas apply only while the box is strictly inactive and $\lambda_B > 0$.

Finally, for sufficiently small $B > 0$, write $\theta = Bz$. The upper bounds are then inactive on $z \geq 0,\ p^\top z \leq 1$, since $z_i \leq 1/p_i$. On this compact set, $(L(Bz) - c)/B = -2h^\top z + Bz^\top M z$ converges uniformly to $-2h^\top z$. Its minimum therefore tends to $-2\max\{0, h_s/S, h_c/C_K\}$, proving the right derivative at zero. No data-dependent active-set heuristic or estimated multiplier is needed for this exact financial sensitivity.

A.6 A bound from feasible KKT diagnostics

For any exactly feasible θ and non-negative multipliers λ, put $r_* = \nabla L(\theta) + A^\top \lambda$, $\varepsilon_c = \lambda^\top (b - A\theta) \geq 0$ and $m_* = \lambda_{\min}(M) > 0$. With $\delta = \theta_* - \theta$, quadratic expansion and feasibility give $L(\theta_*) \geq L(\theta) + r_*^\top \delta + m_* \|\delta\|^2 - \varepsilon_c$. Completing the square and using the optimum's variational inequality yield

$$m_* \|\theta - \theta_*\|^2 \leq L(\theta) - L(\theta_*) \leq \varepsilon_c + \frac{\|r_*\|^2}{4m_*}. \tag{26}$$

The left inequality follows by expanding at θ_* and using $\nabla L(\theta_*)^\top (\theta - \theta_*) \geq 0$. Floating-point feasibility, residuals and eigenvalues do not themselves prove the exact premises or certify this bound.

A.7 Outward feasibility and primal-dual certificates

Primitive inputs and proposed holdings denote exact rationals, including stored binary64 values; prices and moments retain their exact transcendental targets. I evaluate them with outward arithmetic and increase precision until the retained sign and width tests are proved. An exhausted numerical budget is reported as unresolved. Midpoint coefficients supply candidate portfolios, not certified optima.

Write $g_K = D(X - K)^+ - C_K$ and $g_J = D(X - J)^+ - C_J$. Since $Y - V_0 = g_K - g_J$, the residual has the equivalent representation

$$R(\theta) = -\theta_s g_s + (1 - \theta_c) g_K - g_J, \qquad L(\theta) = w^\top \Gamma w, \quad w = (-\theta_s, 1 - \theta_c, -1)^\top, \tag{27}$$

where $\Gamma = \mathbb{E}_P[(g_s, g_K, g_J)^\top (g_s, g_K, g_J)]$. The entries follow from (13) by expansion. For example, the call product vanishes below J and equals $X^2 - (K + J)X + KJ$ above it, so

$$\mathbb{E}_P[(X - K)^+ (X - J)^+] = T_2(J, \infty) - (K + J) T_1(J, \infty) + KJ T_0(J, \infty). \tag{28}$$

This retains the upper-tail contribution when θ_c is near one; g_J is an algebraic auxiliary, not an additional tradable security. The original moment quadratic remains in the archive.

Let $[C_-, C_+]$ and $[V_-, V_+]$ enclose C_K, V_0, with positive lower endpoints. Box an original rational holding to obtain $u \in [0, 1]^2$, and set

$$t = \begin{cases} 1, & u = 0, \\ \min\{1, \kappa V_- / (S u_s + C_+ u_c)\}, & u \neq 0, \end{cases} \qquad \theta = tu. \tag{29}$$

The denominator is positive whenever $u \neq 0$. Consequently $0 \leq \theta \leq 1$ and $S\theta_s + C_K\theta_c \leq S\theta_s + C_+\theta_c \leq \kappa V_- \leq \kappa V_0$. Thus the replacement is exactly feasible, including at zero budget. It can have greater loss than the original holding. Refinement and feasibility repair are separate operations and are reported separately.

Use the true system $A\theta \leq b$ from (5). For any exact $\lambda \in \mathbb{R}^5_+$, put $z = h - A^\top\lambda/2$. Completing the square gives

$$\begin{aligned} L(x) + \lambda^\top(Ax - b) &= (x - M^{-1}z)^\top M(x - M^{-1}z) + d(\lambda), \\ d(\lambda) &= c - \lambda^\top b - z^\top M^{-1}z. \end{aligned} \tag{30}$$

For every feasible x, the left-hand side is at most $L(x)$; its infimum over all $x \in \mathbb{R}^2$ is $d(\lambda)$. Hence $d(\lambda) \leq v(B)$, without requiring exact KKT multipliers or strict feasibility. The choice $\lambda = 0$ gives the unrestricted relaxation $c - h^\top M^{-1}h$. Its optimum is positive by the non-replication argument; a numerical lower endpoint must establish that positivity before it is reported as resolved.

Suppose outward evaluation gives $L(\theta) \in [L_-, L_+]$, $d(\lambda) \in [d_-, d_+]$ and unrestricted loss in $[u_-, u_+]$. Then

$$\underline{v} = \max\{0, d_-, u_-\} \leq v(B) \leq L(\theta) \leq L_+, \qquad E = L_+ - \underline{v}. \tag{31}$$

The independent zero lower bound follows from a squared loss; the raw dual enclosure is retained even if its lower endpoint is negative. This does not replace a negative computed risk by zero. If $M_{11} > 0$, $\det M \geq \delta_- > 0$ and $\operatorname{tr} M \leq s_+$ are proved, then $m_- := \delta_-/s_+ \leq \lambda_{\min}(M)$: positive definiteness follows from Sylvester's criterion and $\lambda_{\max}(M) \leq \operatorname{tr} M$. For a feasible θ, the segment $\theta_* + t(\theta - \theta_*)$ is feasible for $0 \leq t \leq 1$. Its right derivative at zero is non-negative by optimality, so $2(M\theta_* - h)^\top(\theta - \theta_*) \geq 0$. Therefore $L(\theta) - v(B) = 2(M\theta_* - h)^\top(\theta - \theta_*) + (\theta - \theta_*)^\top M(\theta - \theta_*)$, which gives

$$m_-\|\theta - \theta_*\|^2 \leq L(\theta) - v(B) \leq E. \tag{32}$$

All certificate endpoints are exact fractions; decimal displays are secondary summaries.

For the distinct unit-call holding,

$$R(0,1) = C_J - D(X - J)^+, \qquad L(0,1) = D^2\mathbb{E}_P[((X - J)^+)^2] - 2DC_J\mathbb{E}_P[(X - J)^+] + C_J^2. \tag{33}$$

Moreover $C_K - V_0 = C_J > 0$, so this holding is infeasible at $\kappa = 1$. These identities neither describe a different near-unit-call holding nor establish that the original finite Monte Carlo run resolved the rare tail. They are checked applications of established GBM moments and convex duality, without a theoretical-priority claim.

B Physical-drift uncertainty: derivations and certificates

B.1 Gaussian interpolation for a non-negative loss

Let $s^2 = \sigma^2 T$ and $m_\mu = \log S + (\mu - q - \sigma^2/2)T$. The log terminal price has the strictly positive normal density $f_\mu(y) = (2\pi s^2)^{-1/2}\exp\{-(y - m_\mu)^2/(2s^2)\}$. For $a < b$, $t \in [0,1]$ and $\mu = (1-t)a + tb$, expansion of the square gives

$$f_\mu(y) = \exp\left\{\frac{Tt(1-t)(b-a)^2}{2\sigma^2}\right\} f_a(y)^{1-t} f_b(y)^t. \tag{34}$$

For any measurable $\ell : (0,\infty) \to [0,\infty)$ with finite endpoint expectations, apply Hölder with conjugate exponents $1/(1-t)$ and $1/t$ to $(\ell(e^y)f_a(y))^{1-t}(\ell(e^y)f_b(y))^t$. For $0 < t < 1$ this yields

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{E}_\mu\ell(X) &\leq \exp\left\{\frac{Tt(1-t)(b-a)^2}{2\sigma^2}\right\} (\mathbb{E}_a\ell(X))^{1-t}(\mathbb{E}_b\ell(X))^t \\ &\leq \exp\left\{\frac{T(b-a)^2}{8\sigma^2}\right\} \max\{\mathbb{E}_a\ell(X), \mathbb{E}_b\ell(X)\}. \end{aligned} \tag{35}$$

The endpoint cases are identities. If an endpoint expectation vanishes, strict positivity of its density makes $\ell(e^y) = 0$ almost everywhere; all the expectations then vanish and the bound still holds. This proves the result without dividing by a risk that might be zero. The fixed loss $\ell(x) = R(\theta; x)^2$ is independent of μ: the prices, premium, instruments and holdings must be held fixed when applying the identity. Its expectations are finite because the residual grows at most linearly in x and every lognormal second moment is finite. Applying the cell bound on each grid interval proves (11). A one-point grid is permitted only for a singleton drift interval, where $\gamma = 1$.

The cell factor is sharp for the stated class of arbitrary non-negative fixed losses, without asserting sharpness within the particular hedging residual family. Let $m = (m_a + m_b)/2$ and take $\ell_\varepsilon(x) = \mathbf{1}_{\{|\log x - m| < \varepsilon\}}$. Symmetry gives $\mathbb{E}_a \ell_\varepsilon = \mathbb{E}_b \ell_\varepsilon$. Continuity of each Gaussian density gives

$$\lim_{\varepsilon \downarrow 0} \frac{\mathbb{E}_{(a+b)/2} \ell_\varepsilon}{\max\{\mathbb{E}_a \ell_\varepsilon, \mathbb{E}_b \ell_\varepsilon\}} = \frac{f_{(a+b)/2}(m)}{f_a(m)} = \exp\left\{ \frac{T(b-a)^2}{8\sigma^2} \right\}. \tag{36}$$

Indeed each integral divided by 2ε tends to its positive density value at m. No smaller universal factor can therefore replace that in (35). This elementary specialisation makes no assertion of theoretical priority.

B.2 Convexity, uniqueness and discretisation error

The moment formulas in Appendix A are continuous in μ. Thus $(\mu, \theta) \mapsto L_\mu(\theta)$ is continuous on the compact product $I \times \mathcal{F}_B$. Its maximum F_I is continuous: uniform continuity of L makes the difference of the maxima at two holdings no larger than $\sup_{\mu \in I} |L_\mu(\theta) - L_\mu(\eta)|$. The earlier positive-definiteness argument holds for every finite μ. The variational identity $\lambda_{\min}(M_\mu) = \min_{\|u\|=1} u^\top M_\mu u$ and compactness therefore give

$$m_* := \min_{\mu \in I} \lambda_{\min}(M_\mu) > 0. \tag{37}$$

Indeed this minimum is attained on I times the unit sphere, and a zero minimum would contradict positive definiteness at its attaining drift. For $0 < t < 1$, exact quadratic expansion gives

$$\begin{aligned} L_\mu(t\theta + (1-t)\eta) &= tL_\mu(\theta) + (1-t)L_\mu(\eta) - t(1-t)(\theta - \eta)^\top M_\mu(\theta - \eta) \\ &\le tF_I(\theta) + (1-t)F_I(\eta) - m_* t(1-t)\|\theta - \eta\|^2. \end{aligned} \tag{38}$$

Taking the supremum on the left proves strong convexity of F_I. Its minimum on the nonempty compact convex feasible set is attained and unique, including the singleton set at zero budget. For its optimiser θ_I, substitute $\eta = \theta_I$ and use minimality on the segment; after dividing by t and taking $t \downarrow 0$, this gives

$$m_* \|\theta - \theta_I\|^2 \le F_I(\theta) - v_I. \tag{39}$$

A numerical distance certificate requires a separately validated lower bound on m_*; pointwise grid eigenvalues alone do not bound it uniformly.

Let $v_G = \min_{\mathcal{F}_B} \max_j L_{\mu_j}$. Both grid and continuum minima exist. Evaluate the envelope at their respective optimisers to get

$$v_G \le v_I \le \gamma v_G, \qquad 0 \le v_I - v_G \le (\gamma - 1) v_G. \tag{40}$$

For $\delta \le \delta_0$, the inequality $e^x - 1 \le x e^x$ gives $\gamma - 1 \le [T/(8\sigma^2)] e^{T\delta_0^2/(8\sigma^2)} \delta^2$. This is a multiplicative second-order grid bound; it does not assert second-order convergence of the holdings. A feasible numerical candidate with grid upper bound U and any lower bound $d \le v_G$ instead yields (12). Relative statements require a strictly positive lower bound. No division by zero or clipping of a negative computed squared-loss interval is justified.

B.3 Finite-mixture weak duality

Write the five true funding/box inequalities as $A\theta \le b$. Choose exact weights $w_j \ge 0$ with $\sum_j w_j = 1$, and any exact $\lambda \in [0,\infty)^5$. These weights are an optimisation witness, not a financial prior or an assertion that a mixture law is itself GBM. Put $\overline{M} = \sum_j w_j M_{\mu_j}$, $\overline{h} = \sum_j w_j h_{\mu_j}$ and $\overline{c} = \sum_j w_j c_{\mu_j}$. The matrix $\overline{M}$ is positive definite, since at least one positive weight multiplies a positive-definite quadratic form. For every feasible θ,

$$\begin{aligned}\max_j L_{\mu_j}(\theta) &\ge \sum_j w_j L_{\mu_j}(\theta) + \lambda^\top (A\theta - b) \\ &= \overline{c} - \lambda^\top b - z^\top \overline{M}^{-1} z + (\theta - \overline{M}^{-1} z)^\top \overline{M} (\theta - \overline{M}^{-1} z), \qquad z = \overline{h} - \tfrac{1}{2} A^\top \lambda. \end{aligned} \tag{41}$$

Dropping the last non-negative term and taking the infimum proves that $d(w,\lambda) = \overline{c} - \lambda^\top b - z^\top \overline{M}^{-1} z$ is a lower bound on v_G and hence v_I. No constraint qualification, optimiser convergence claim or strong-duality assertion is needed. Outward arithmetic evaluates this expression and each candidate grid loss at the true model costs. An exact rational mixture of approximate solver weights must be renormalised exactly; negative weights or multipliers cannot enter this witness. If the raw dual lower endpoint is negative, the independent mathematical bound 0 may strengthen it, with both values retained. A numerical proposal solves a conservative nearby problem only; true feasibility, primal risk and dual bounds remain independently checked.

B.4 Known-volatility finite-sample drift uncertainty

Fix an integer $n \ge 1$, spacing $\Delta > 0$, and a known $\sigma > 0$. Under the stipulated historical model, let independent logreturns satisfy

$$H_i = (\mu - q - \sigma^2/2)\Delta + \sigma\sqrt{\Delta}\, Z_i, \qquad Z_i \overset{\text{iid}}{\sim} N(0,1). \tag{42}$$

The future return is independent of this history conditional on the fixed model parameters. The exact unrounded estimate $\widetilde{\mu} = q + \sigma^2/2 + (n\Delta)^{-1}\sum_i H_i$ satisfies $(n\Delta)(\widetilde{\mu} - \mu)^2/\sigma^2 \sim \chi^2_1$. Suppose retained rational observations r_i obey deterministic bounds $|r_i - H_i| \le \rho_i$. For $0 < \alpha < 1$, choose a rational $Q > 0$ with $\mathbb{P}(\chi^2_1 > Q) \le \alpha$ and a rational $w \ge 0$ satisfying $w^2 \ge \sigma^2 Q/(n\Delta)$. Define

$$\begin{aligned}\widehat{\mu} &= q + \sigma^2/2 + (n\Delta)^{-1}\sum_i r_i, \\ \rho &= (n\Delta)^{-1}\sum_i \rho_i, \qquad I = [\widehat{\mu} - \rho - w, \widehat{\mu} + \rho + w]. \end{aligned} \tag{43}$$

The triangle inequality gives $|\widehat{\mu} - \widetilde{\mu}| \le \rho$; therefore $\mathbb{P}_\mu(\mu \notin I) \le \alpha$ exactly under this model. A certified quantile upper bound can be obtained by verifying $\operatorname{erfc}(\sqrt{Q/2}) \le \alpha$ with outward arithmetic. A rational square-root upper bound can be verified by exact squaring, so floating-point quantiles and square roots are not assumed exact. This is not the unknown-volatility Student interval, and a volatility confidence interval must not be substituted without a new argument.

Let a measurable algorithm, using the history and any internal random numbers, either fail explicitly or return exactly feasible holdings $\widehat{\theta}$, an interval I, and an upper bound $U_I \ge F_I(\widehat{\theta})$. On the event $\mu \in I$, this deterministic certificate implies $L_\mu(\widehat{\theta}) \le U_I$, even though the holdings and interval were chosen from the history. Consequently

$$\mathbb{P}_\mu\{\text{success and } L_\mu(\widehat{\theta}) > U_I\} \le \alpha. \tag{44}$$

The claim is about the conditional future mean-square risk of the chosen holdings, not about a realised squared future error being below U_I. It gives no $1-\alpha$ coverage conditional on successful return unless that further selection issue is separately controlled.

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